Edward Tait

Composer, Pianist & Educator, based in London.

Email: edwardtait06@outlook.com | **Website**: www.edtait.com

Composition Performance Highlights

my troubled sense doth move — Gonzaga Band, Royal Birmingham Conservatoire; subsequently broadcast on **BBC Radio 3**'s *Early Music Show* (2026)

Frühlingslied — Ansel Chaloner-Hughes, Christ Church Worthing (2026); MetroLand Music Festival (2026)

Ashes Beneath the Ice — Pavel Kushnir Scholarship *Music of War* Concert, Leighton House, Holland Park (2026)

Engineer's Paradise — workshop with Simon Callaghan, Clíodna Shanahan & Richard Sisson, Conway Hall Clements Prize (2026)

Fleeting Manhattan — Rotherham Symphony Orchestra (2025); Orion Orchestra, conducted by Nicholas Daniel, St John's Smith Square (2024)

In the Bleak Midwinter — masterclass with Phillip Cooke, London Festival of Contemporary Church Music; subsequently performed at Holy Sepulchre Church (2025); Lloyd's Choir, Katharine Cree Church (2024)

Preluded — Arquia Duo, St John's Church Fulham (2025); Purcell Soloists, Amersham Free Church (2024)

Rhapsodism — London Sinfonietta *Sound Out Schools*, Royal Festival Hall (2025) and Dugdale Arts Centre (2024)

Ballade — commissioned and performed by Trio Amabile, York Late Music (2024)

Night Fantasy — workshop with Robert Saxton, premiered by Peter Sheppard-Skærved, Purcell School (2024)

Passage of Time — Carducci Quartet, Chiltern Arts Festival (2023)

Waltzing Matilda — Westminster Abbey, Commonwealth Day Pre-Service (2023)

Mo Li Hua — Purcell Sinfonietta, Hatfield House Music Festival (2022)

Additional performances in composition concerts at the Royal Academy of Music (2024–26), Purcell School (2018–26) and University of Cambridge workshops (2025–26).

Projects & Research

After the Crossing (2026)

Six site-specific organ improvisations responding to the distinctive qualities of each organ, church and surrounding landscape, presented within solo organ recitals across the Isle of Wight alongside Purcell, Elgar and original music.

Highbury (2025–)

Adaptation of original, reality-based tales and sketches into a full-length narrative novella; self-published through Amazon Kindle Direct Publishing.

ImprovForty (2024–25)

Recorded and released solo improvisations for 40 consecutive days to develop pianistic fluency; followed by *Scriabivisations*, exploring improvisation in the styles of Scriabin's compositional periods.

Amersham Summer (2024)

Debut film production of **Eskonfilm**, featuring an entirely improvised cello-and-piano soundtrack, followed by *Caledonian Voyage* and *Commuting Phases*. Recorded with cellist Nicola Tait-Baxter.

Composers Parallels (2024)

Two chamber works by Edward Tait & Antonia Zadrag responding to Shostakovich, performed alongside two of his works, at the **Purcell Pulse Festival** (2024). Followed by a 2026 Bach-inspired collaboration with Jacques Cohen and Purcell School composers, workshopped/performed by Shirley Turner (violin), Peter Mallinson (viola) & Richard Pearce (piano).

The Planets: Reimagined (2023)

Writing and publishing the first complete piano transcription of Holst's *The Planets*; premiered at the Purcell School with five student pianists.

Employment & Work Experience

Royal Academy of Music (selected work)

Students' Union Sub-Team Representative – Student representation; freshers' welcome events; organising and recruiting for RAM football club; study session supervision (2026–27)

Events Management Team – Stage management, classroom set-up and backstage concert preparation (2026–)

Widening Participation Composers Club – Composition mentoring; outreach workshops and assemblies (2026)

Students Create Festival – Visual technician for *The Daoshi Ballads* multimedia project (2026)

RAM Museum – Gallery Assistant; instrument handling, display and visitor tours (2026)

Expericademy – Conducting, group improvisation and performance, curation and video editing; debut performance at the Royal Academy of Music Students Create Festival (2024–25)

Artistic Director, MetroLand Music Festival (2025–)

Programming and organising concert seasons; curation, commissioning and fundraising; stage management, publicity, programme design and social media; organ registration. **Canva**, **Microsoft Excel**.

Accompanist, Heatherton Singers (2025–)

Choral accompanying and tuning, sight-reading, solo performance, keyboard arranging, sheet music formatting.

Freelance Music Teacher (2024–)

GCSE composition and music theory; private piano tuition (1-to-1 and classes); practice examinations. 3+ years of teaching experience.

Freelance Composer (2023–)

Commissions and arrangements for chamber, orchestra, vocal, film, media and theatre; orchestration, part-making, typesetting and digital copyist work for performance and recording across the UK and Ireland.

100+ original works; selected music and arrangements published by NoteWelder Music since 2024.

Freelance Timpanist & Percussionist (2023–)

Regular professional work with Rose Opera, Bridgewater Sinfonia, Chorleywood Orchestra, Trinity Orchestra, Mysticus Sinfonia, Corinthian Orchestra, Ealing Symphony Orchestra and Holland Park Sinfonia; additional depping for 20+ orchestras and opera companies; experience with tuned and non-tuned percussion.

Extensive orchestral fixing experience across regular orchestral, opera and choral ensembles.

Web Developer, EPT Websites (2023–)

Web design, programming, biography/CV writing, digital catalogues, online marketing and video editing, specialising in professional musician websites. **Visual Studio Code**, **CapCut**.

Composition Mentor, London Sinfonietta Sound Out Schools (2024–25)

Interactive assemblies and workshops, GCSE mentoring, notation software assistance, chamber orchestration.

Co-director, Purcell Creative Ensemble (2022–24)

Rehearsal leadership, conducting, chamber piano performance and concert marketing; writing programme notes for major concerts throughout 2023–24, alongside extensive contributions to **Purcell Highlights Newsletter**.

Co-director, IMPULSE Outreach Project (2023)

Conducting, interactive assemblies, sheet music management; hosted by the Yorke Trust, North Norfolk.

Additional experience: Bechstein Hall (stewarding); Charlton Sunday Series (curation); Belmont Ensemble (stewarding and page turning); Octagon Music Society (social media); Charles Tait Accounting (payroll and accounts processing); Oliver Davis (studio recording assistance).

Piano Performance

Extensive solo and chamber performance, typically **9–12 recitals annually** across UK church venues, regularly including original compositions. Additional accompanying and orchestral piano experience with the Royal Academy of Music, Harrow Arts Centre, Sophia Haglia Choir, Jaques Samuel Pianos and St Andrew's Chorleywood.

Selected Performances

Solo recital: Chopin, Ravel & Grieg — St Alkmund's Church, Whitchurch (2026)

Solo recital: Ravel, Liszt & Scriabin — St Michael's Church, Highgate (2026)

Elgar Violin Sonata, with Luca Weed — Beaconsfield Lunchtime Series (2026); MetroLand Music Festival (2026)

Satie *Vexations* — 40-hour performance marathon with eight pianists; fundraising for **Help Musicians** (2025)

CFMM Shrewsbury Piano Showcase — St Alkmund's Church, Shrewsbury (2025)

Shostakovich Piano Trio No. 1 — Purcell Pulse Festival, Vigneron Piano Trio (2024)

Selected Repertoire

Prokofiev Sonata No. 4; Chopin *Barcarolle*, Ballade No. 1; Ravel *Jeux d'eau*, *Sonatine*; Scriabin Sonata No. 4; Liszt *Années de pèlerinage*; Elgar Violin Sonata; Tchaikovsky *Dumka*

Education & Training

Royal Academy of Music, London

BMus in Composition (2024–28) — Professors: Gareth Moorcraft, Louise Drewett

Electives: Keyboard Skills (Nicholas Walker)

Academic study: Analytical Skills (Emily Kilpatrick, Alex Hills); Aural Skills (Jennifer Sheppard, Christopher Atkinson); Multimedia & Creative Technology (Phil Dawson); Notation (Ash Mistry, Gareth Lockrane); Orchestration & Repertoire (Louise Drewett); Techniques of Composition (Gareth Moorcraft).

Additional composition lessons: Eleanor Alberga, Rubens Askenar, Morgan Hayes, Philip Cashian, Edmund Finnis, Ryan Latimer, Helen Grime

Purcell School for Young Musicians

Composition (2017–24): Jacques Cohen, Brian Elias, Deborah Pritchard — **UK Music & Dance Scheme Scholar**

Piano (2017–24), Lidia Amorelli; ABRSM Grade 8 — Distinction (2022)

Conducting (2020–24), Jacques Cohen, Irina Walters

Cello (2017–19), Julian Metzger; ABRSM Grade 5 — Merit (2018)

Seminars with Judith Weir, Zoe Martlew, Julian Anderson, Errollyn Wallen & Grace-Evangeline Mason.

Conductor, Philomel (2023–24); Organiser of student-led composer concerts premiering 20+ new works.

A-Levels: History, Literature & Music (2022–24)

Additional Training

Guildhall School of Music & Drama — Composition (2026), Matthew King & Paul Whitmarsh

National Film & Television School — Composing for Film & TV (2025), Mathias Nielsen

Chiltern Music Academy — Cello (2014–17), Mary Walton

Independent Study — Composition & Theory (2014–17), Andrew Melvin; Piano (2012–17), James Kellas

Competitions & Awards

Shortlist, Aurora Choir Carol Composition Competition (2026)

Shortlist, York Early Music Christmas Festival Commission (2026)

Winner, National Centre for Early Music Young Composer Award (2026) — *my troubled sense doth move*; workshop/performance with Christopher Fox & Gonzaga Band

Winner, London Festival of Contemporary Church Music Call-for-Scores (2025)

Winner, New Jersey Garden State Singers Call for Scores (2025) — *It was a lover and his lass*, performed in Ridgefield Park, New Jersey, USA

Shortlist, Conway Hall Clements Prize for Composers (2025)

Winner, Tiziano Rossetti Competition (2025)

Highly Commended, Berlioz International Music Competition (2024)

Winner, Purcell School Tim Stevenson Prize for Outstanding Composition (2024)

Finalist, European Recording Orchestra Call for Scores (2024) — resulting in masterclasses with Arthur Brouns, Francisco Rios & Christopher Young, at the **Film Scoring Academy of Europe**

Best Composer, North London Festival (2019)

Winner, Chesham Arts Festival Composition Prize (2019)

Winner, Beacon Young Musician of the Year Junior Award (2017)

Last Updated: 24th October 2026